

- ❖ 标蓝词汇是期末考试第一道大题的复习范围。老师要求同学们记忆所有标蓝词汇的词义。

Unit 1 Text A

There are two things I have always wanted to do - write and live on a farm. Today I'm doing both. I am not in E. B. White's class as a writer or in my neighbors' league as a farmer, but I'm **getting by**(to manage to live with difficulty). And after years of **frustration** with city and suburban living, my wife Sandy and I have finally found **contentment**(=satisfaction) here in the country.

It's a **self-reliant** sort of life. We grow nearly all of our fruits and vegetables. Our hens keep us in eggs, with several dozen left over to sell each week. Our bees provide us with honey, and we cut enough wood to just about **make it through**(=to survive) the heating season.

It's a satisfying life too. In the summer we **canoe** on the river, go picnicking in the woods and take long bicycle rides. In the winter we ski and skate. We get excited about sunsets. We love the smell of the earth warming and the sound of **cattle** lowing. We **watch for**¹ hawks in the sky and deer in the cornfields.

1. Watch for = look for, 表示搜寻, 找寻;

Watch out! = Look out! 表示“小心!”“看着点!”“警惕些!”

But the good life can get pretty **tough**(hard, laborious). Three months ago when it was 30 below, we spent two **miserable** days hauling firewood up the river on a sled. Three month from now, it will be 95 above and we will be **cultivating** corn, **weeding** strawberries and killing chickens. Recently, Sandy and I had to retille the back roof. Soon Jim, 16 and Emily, 13, the youngest of our four children, will help me make some **long-overdue**² improvements on the outdoor toilet that **supplements**³ our indoor plumbing when we are working outside. Later this month, we'll **spray** the orchard, paint the barn, plant the garden and clean the hen house before the new chicks arrive.

2. Long-overdue: being delayed for a long time. E.g. The USTC library asks for the list of students with overdue books. (科大图书馆要一份列有欠书未还的学生名单。)

3. Supplement here means to extend, to stretch 表示延伸; 原文的意思是, “孩子们帮着我一起将拖沓了很久未整修的水管翻修了, 这根水管从室内一直延伸到户外厕所。”

In between such **chores**(house chores 家务活), I manage to spend 50 to 60 hours a week at the typewriter or doing reporting for the freelance articles I sell to magazines and newspapers. Sandy, meanwhile, **pursues** her own **demanding schedule**(严格的作息). Besides the usual household routine, she **oversees**⁴ the garden and beehives, bakes bread, cans and **freezes**, drives the kids to their music lessons, practices with them, takes organ lessons on her own, does research and typing for me, writes an article herself now and then, **tends**⁵ the flower beds, **stacks**⁶ a little wood and **delivers** the eggs. There is, as the old saying goes, no rest for the wicked on a place like this - and not much for the virtuous either.

4. Oversee: examine, supervise 监管, 监督, 管理; overlook: ignore 忽略

5. Tend 最普遍的用法是趋于, E.g. Supply **tends to** become rarer. 商品供应越发少了。而此处的 tend 为实义动词, 表示培育, 培植, 照顾. The female **tends** the hatchlings for

10 days. 母性动物会前后十天照顾刚孵化不久的小崽崽们。除了 tend, 我们还学到了 nurture, culture, 皆表示培育, 培植。

6. Stack, 表示堆, 和 pile 很像。如图像所示:



A stack of books

None of us will ever forget our first winter. We were buried under five feet of snow from December through march. While one storm after another **blasted**(卷起, 吹起) huge drifts(=masses of snow) up against the house and barn, we kept warm inside burning our own wood, eating our own apples and loving every minute of it.

When spring came, it brought two floods. First the river overflowed, covering much of our land for weeks. Then the growing season began, **swamping**(=overwhelm, overflow, flood) us under wave after wave of produce. Our freezer filled up with cherries... peas, beans and corn. Then our canned-goods **shelves**(货架) and **cupboards**(碗柜) began to grow with **preserves**(酱、腌制罐头), tomato juice, grape juice, plums... Eventually, the **basement** floor disappeared under piles of potatoes, squash and pumpkins, and the barn began to fill with apples and pears. It was amazing.

The next year we grew even more food and managed to get through the winter on firewood that was mostly from our own trees and only 100 gallons of heating oil. At that point I began thinking seriously about quitting my job and starting to freelance. The **timing**(时机; “天时地利人和”中的“天时”可以用 **good timing**) was terrible. By then, Shawn and Amy, our oldest girls were attending expensive Ivy League schools and we had only a few thousand dollars in the bank. Yet we kept coming back to the same question: Will there ever be a better time? The answer, decidedly, was no, and so - with my employer's blessings and half a year's pay in **accumulated** benefits in my pocket - off I went⁷.

7. Off I went. 副词提前的倒装。再如 Up it went. There she goes.

作者此句用倒装的用意有几点: 1, 突出 off 一词。Off (I went) 开头比 I (went off.) 开头更加开门见山, 可以翻译为“**转头就走人**”; 2, 强调“离的坚决”, “走的干脆”。

There have been a few **anxious**(=worrying 让人焦虑的, 让人忧心忡忡的) moments since then, but **on balance** things have gone much better than we had any right to expect. For various stories of mine, I've **crawled** into black bear **dens**(兽窝) for *Sports Illustrated*, hitched up dogsled **racing team** for *Smithsonian* magazine, checked out the Lake Champlain “monster” for *Science Digest*, and canoed through the Boundary Waters **wilderness**(=nature 荒野, 蛮荒之地) area of Minnesota for *Destinations*.⁸

8. 这一段怎么理解? 作者讲, 为某一个杂志套上雪橇, 爬进熊洞, 探索湖怪等等。我们可以这样转译, 如第二个分句 “(I) hitched up dogsled racing team for *Smithsonian*

magazine” = I hitched up dogsled racing team in order to record the event and write a report on it. I then submitted the article to *Smithsonian* magazine. 同样, “I’ve crawled into black bear dens(兽窝) for *Sports Illustrated*” = In order to submit successfully an article to *Sports Illustrated* magazine, I had to crawl into the black bear dens to have something to write about. 作者亲力亲为, 才能写成并投稿成功。

I’m not making anywhere near⁹ as much money as I did when I was employed full time, but now we don’t need as much either. I **generate**(该词要学会应用; 此处含义为: earn) enough income to handle our \$600-a-month mortgage payments plus the usual expenses for a family like ours. That includes everything from music lessons and dental bills to car repairs and college costs. When it comes to insurance, we have a poor man’s major-medical policy. We have to pay the first \$500 of any medical fees for each member of the family. It **picks up(=cover)** 80% of the costs beyond that. Although we **are stuck with(=be burdened with)** paying minor expenses, our premium is low - only \$560 a year - and we are covered against **catastrophe**. Aside from that and the policy on our two cars at \$400 a year, we have no other insurance. But we are **setting aside(=save)** \$2000 a year in an IRA.

9. Anywhere near 表示程度, 几乎, 作者的意思是现在挣的钱和以前基本不在一个水平。比 anywhere near 程度再深的是 nowhere near, 表示完全。

I’m not making anywhere near as much money as I did... ≈ I’m making nowhere near as much money as I did...

We’ve been able to make up the difference in income by cutting back without **appreciably(=obviously)** lowering our standard of living. We continue to dine out once or twice a month, but now we **patronize**¹⁰ local restaurants instead of more expensive places in the city. We still attend the opera and ballet in Milwaukee but only a few times a year. We eat less meat, drink cheaper wine and see fewer movies. **Extravagant(奢侈的, 排场大的)** Christmases are a memory, and we **combine** vacations **with** story assignments...

10. Patronise 在原文里, 其实就表示 eat, dine。这个词来源于法语的 patron, 指的是赞助商, 出资方, 主顾。顾客去餐厅消费, 也可以理解成为餐厅提供金钱赞助, 顾客是出资方, 因此 patronise 为惠顾, 光顾(某生意)。看老师这么讲, 同学们是不是更能理解。

I **suspect**¹¹ not everyone who loves the country would be happy living the way we do. It takes a couple of special qualities. One is a **tolerance** for **solitude**. Because we are so busy and on such a **tight budget(勒紧裤腰带, 节省开支)**, we don’t entertain much. During the growing season there is no time for **socialising**¹² anyway. Jim and Emily are involved in school activities, but they too spend most of their time at home. The other requirement is energy - a lot of it. The way to make self-sufficiency(=self-reliance, self-dependence) work on a small scale is to **resist** the **temptation** to buy a tractor and other expensive laborsaving **devices(=tools)**. Instead, you do the work yourself. The only machinery we own is a little three-horsepower rotary cultivator and a 16-inch chain saw.

11. 此处的 suspect 表示 Imagine, guess, 猜想。E.g. I suspect he’s right. 我想他是对的。

12. Socialise (英式), socialize (美式) 社交。同样, patronise 是英式, patronize 为美式。

How much longer we'll have enough energy to stay on here is anybody's guess - perhaps for quite a while, perhaps not. When the time comes, we'll leave with a feeling of **sorrow** but also with **a sense of pride** at what we've been able to **accomplish**. We should make a **fair**¹³ profit on the sale of the place, too. We've **invested** about \$35,000 of our own money in it, and we could just about double that if we sold today. But this is not a good time to sell. Once economic conditions improve, however, demand for farms like ours should be strong again.

13. Fair 是一个内涵非常丰富的词。同学们要学会应用。

Fair 作为形容词，表示 1，公平的，公正的 e.g. a fair competition 公平的竞争；

2，既然是公平公正，不偏颇，不斜倚，处于中间位置，那么，fair 的第二层形容词含义为 一般化的，不好不坏，中等水平的，e.g. a fair painting 一副不怎么出彩的画；a fair weather 天气还行；a fair chance of winning 差不多能赢.....

Fairly 为副词，有几种含义：1，=nearly 相当，完全地 The phenomenon is fairly universal. 这种现象相当普遍；a fairly easy task 一个相当容易的任务；2，公正地 The competition is fairly organised.

We didn't move here **primarily**(最初地，当初) to earn money though. We came because we wanted to improve the quality of our lives. When I watch Emily collecting eggs in the evening, fishing with Jim on the river or enjoying an old-fashioned picnic in the **orchard**(果园) with the entire family, I know we've found just what we were looking for.